

UX Analysis of Datalign Advisory Intake Form

Context

On **31 July 2025** (America/New_York), I went through the multi-step intake form at **form.datalignadvisory.com**. The form is intended to match a user with a financial advisor, and it is organised into four sections (Services, Finances, Investing and Match). Each step uses a minimalistic card with a question, a grey **"Why we ask"** link and a round arrow icon to move forward. Below is a summary of observations and improvement opportunities based on the current flow.

Strengths

- **Clean, uncluttered layout:** The form uses plenty of whitespace and a consistent card design, making each question easy to read. A static footer states Datalign's fiduciary duty, privacy policy and the objective of the questionnaire, which helps establish trust.
- **Grouping of questions:** Dividing the process into **Services, Finances, Investing** and **Match** provides a logical flow. Within the Finances section, the form asks about age, marital status, profession and homeownership, which helps the advisor understand the user's situation.
- **"Prefer not to say" options:** For sensitive questions such as marital status and profession, the form offers a **"Prefer not to say"** option ¹, respecting user privacy.
- **Educational tooltip:** The mid-flow "Did you know?" card explains potential benefits of working with a financial advisor and cites Vanguard research ². When relevant, the **"Why we ask"** link appears next to questions to explain the purpose of collecting certain information.
- **Security messaging:** Several cards state that data are encrypted and will not be shared without consent ³, which reassures users.

Pain points and opportunities for improvement

Area	Issues & suggested improvements	Evidence
Navigation & accessibility	• Progression is handled by a single round arrow icon without a text label. This icon functions as "Next" and, on subsequent steps, another icon functions as "Back". Users with visual impairments or unfamiliarity with icons may find this confusing. Adding explicit "Next" and "Back" labels or buttons would improve clarity and accessibility (screen readers can also better announce them).	

Area	Issues & suggested improvements	Evidence
• There is no explicit indication of how many steps are left. A progress bar (e.g., "Step 5 of 12") would set expectations and reduce drop-off.	On every card the only forward control is an arrow icon ⁴; there is no labelled navigation or progress indicator beyond the section names.	
Question wording & inclusivity	• Some questions use limited or oversimplified options. For example, the age question only provides ranges "Under 30", "30s", "40s", "50s", "60+" ⁵. Users in their 70s, 80s or 90s may not feel represented. Provide more inclusive ranges or let users enter their birth year.	
• The marital-status question offers Yes/No plus "Prefer not to say" ¹ but does not cover situations such as partnered, separated or widowed.		
• The "How do you currently manage your portfolio?" question lists a mix of options (self-managed, robo-advisor, 401(k)/IRA, advisor, "I don't know") ⁴. It might be clearer to ask "Which of the following describes how you manage your investments?" and allow multiple selections.		
• The "Why we ask" pop-ups often contain generic marketing copy rather than specific explanations. For instance, after clicking on the first "How do you manage your portfolio?" question, the explanation reads: <i>"Team up with an advisor who understands your financial experience inside out..."</i> ⁶ rather than explaining why the answer matters. Replace these with concise, user-centred explanations, e.g., "This helps us match you with advisors experienced in self-managed vs. professionally managed portfolios."	Age ranges stop at 60+ ⁵; marital-status question lacks inclusive options ¹; "Why we ask" explanation is marketing oriented ⁶.	

Area	Issues & suggested improvements	Evidence
Form controls & input methods	• Several financial questions use sliders that are hard to control precisely. For example, the “How are your current savings approximately allocated?” card starts with all funds pre-allocated to “Other (excluding crypto)” (default \$800,000), and the total cannot be adjusted ⁷. Many users won’t relate to an arbitrary total, and dragging multiple sliders to redistribute is tedious. Use a simpler input, such as entering approximate amounts or selecting ranges (e.g., “\$0–50k”, “\$50–250k”).	
• Similarly, the “What is your estimated current household annual income?” uses a single slider starting at \$0 ³. Sliders without tick marks make it hard to choose a specific value. Use discrete ranges or a numeric input with formatting and validation instead.		
• For open-ended fields (profession, zip code, names), show labels within or above the fields. The email/zip code step appears after the zip-code entry, but the email field is auto-pre-populated with the previously entered zip code, which is clearly a bug ⁸. Ensure that each field is independent and validated (e.g., check for an @ sign in the email).	The savings allocation slider defaults all funds to “Other” (\$800 k) ⁷; the income slider uses a continuous bar starting at \$0 ³; after entering a zip code, the email field incorrectly contains the zip code value ⁸.	
Flow & user friction	• It is unclear which questions are required. Some questions allow “Prefer not to say”, but others (age, net worth, investment confidence) do not. Provide clear indicators (e.g., asterisks) and allow skipping non-essential questions.	
• The educational “Did you know?” interlude provides interesting statistics ² but interrupts the momentum of completing the questionnaire. Consider moving such content to the confirmation screen or making it dismissible.		

Area	Issues & suggested improvements	Evidence
	The final step requests personal information (email, first name, last name). Without context, users may not know why this is required. The adjacent “Why we ask” should clearly explain that advisors need contact details to reach out and that information is protected under the privacy policy.	
	After submission, users should ideally receive confirmation on when they can expect to hear from a matched advisor. Provide a summary page rather than immediately collecting personal data.	The form includes an interlude card with a tip about potential returns ² ; the final card asks for email and names without a clear explanation ⁸ .
Language & tone		Some copy reads as sales-driven (“Team up with an advisor who understands your financial experience...”) ⁶ and may make users feel pressured. A neutral tone focused on the user’s goals (e.g., “Tell us about your investment preferences so we can find advisors experienced in those areas”) builds trust.
	Avoid jargon (e.g., “Employer-sponsored 401(k)” might confuse some users; consider adding “Work retirement plan (401k)” or a tooltip).	
Privacy & trust		Although the form mentions data encryption and a privacy policy ³ , the policy link at the bottom could be more prominent. Since the form collects personally identifiable information (name, email, zip code, household income), a brief summary of data usage and the ability to download the privacy policy would increase transparency.
	Add a checkbox for consent to receive outreach from matched advisors, ensuring compliance with privacy regulations.	The only privacy statement appears under the slider questions and contact form ³ ; there is no explicit consent checkbox.

Summary recommendations

1. **Improve navigation and accessibility:** Use labelled “Next”/“Back” buttons instead of unlabeled arrows, and add a progress indicator showing the current step out of the total. Ensure elements are keyboard-accessible and that screen-reader labels are descriptive.
2. **Increase inclusivity:** Expand or allow free-form entry for age and marital status; ensure “Prefer not to say” or “Other” options exist for every sensitive question. Avoid making assumptions (e.g., not everyone plans to retire or owns a home).
3. **Revise input controls:** Replace sliders for savings and income with simpler range selectors or open numeric inputs; fix the bug where zip-code input populates the email field ⁸.
4. **Clarify “Why we ask” explanations:** Replace generic promotional messages with specific, user-centred reasons for each question. This helps users feel comfortable sharing sensitive information.
5. **Refine the flow:** Minimise interruptions (e.g., move educational interludes to a confirmation page); clearly indicate required fields and allow skipping; provide a summary page before asking for contact details.
6. **Ensure transparent privacy practices:** Make the privacy policy link prominent, summarise how data will be used, and include a consent checkbox before submission.
7. **Use neutral, user-centred language:** Remove marketing heavy phrases and clarify terminology with tooltips or examples where necessary.

By addressing these issues, Datalign Advisory can make the intake process more inclusive, accessible and trustworthy, leading to higher completion rates and better-quality matches for users.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 Match With A Financial Advisor

<https://form.datalignadvisory.com/>

8 Match With A Financial Advisor

view-source:<https://form.datalignadvisory.com/>